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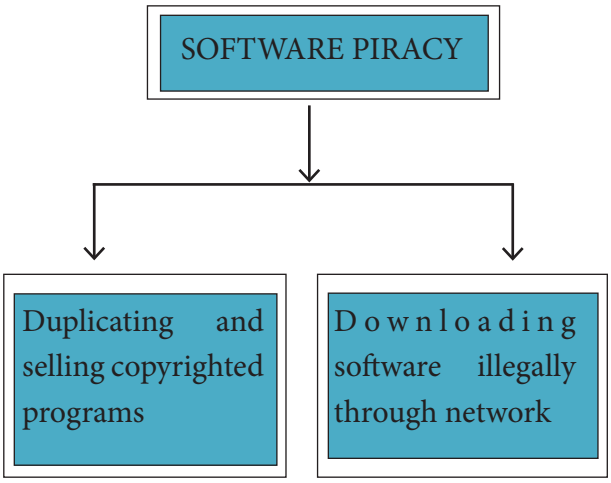

Figure 17.2- Diagrammatic representation of Software piracy

Most of the commercial software is licensed for use at a single computer site or for use by only one user at any time. When a user buys any software, he becomes a licensed user for that software. He is allowed to make copies of the program for backup purposes, but it is against the law to distribute duplicate copies to others. Such illegal copying and distribution of commercial software should not be practiced.

An entirely different approach to software piracy is called shareware, acknowledges the futility of trying to stop people from copying software and instead relies on people's honesty. Shareware publishers encourage users to give copies of programs to friends and colleagues but ask everyone who uses that program regularly to pay a registration fee to the program's author directly. Commercial programs that are made available to the public illegally are often called warez.

UNAUTHORIZED ACCESS

Unauthorized access is when someone gains access to a website, program, server, service, or other system by breaking into a legitimate user account. For example, if someone tries guessing a password or username for an account that was not theirs until they gained access, it is considered an unauthorized access.

To prevent unauthorized access, Firewalls, **Intrusion Detection Systems** (IDS), Virus and Content Scanners, Patches and Hot fixes are used.

HACKING

Hacking is intruding into a computer system to steal personal data without the owner's permission or knowledge (liketo steal a password). It is also gaining unauthorized access to a computer system, and altering its contents. It may be done in pursuit of a criminal activity or it may be a hobby. Hacking may be harmless if the hacker is only enjoying the challenge of breaking systems' defenses, but such ethical hacking should be practiced only as controlled experiments. **Figure 17.4** shows a diagrammatic representation of Hacking.